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Upwardly Mobile

Are you up to creating the apps that will enhance increasingly smart phones?

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Operating systems and installable software are no longer associated with just PCs: mobile phones have very rapidly evolved to being computers on the go, with the ability to do almost everything a PC can—Internet browsing, word processing, multimedia, games, and more. With operators offering more value-added services such as downloadable games, the demand for mobile applications is growing.

To cater to this demand, many large software services companies have a division dedicated to the development of applications and / or games for the mobile platform. Then there are smaller game development companies that have a division working on games for mobiles (or wireless devices as they are called). That's not all—online entertainment/content providers are also looking at reaching out to a wider audience through mobile phones.

All these factors have taken mobile application development from infancy to adulthood with an ample boost of hormones.

The Mobile Vs. The PC Platforms

At this point, it is natural to wonder why mobile application development is viewed differently from development for the PC platform—aren't they the same, or at least similar? Well, in both cases, what's involved is coding, testing, debugging, optimising and such. You need analytical skills and in-depth knowledge of the development tool and the target platform. When it comes to mobile devices, however, there are certain constraints that make writing the software more challenging.

Says Alok Sood, founder and COO of Jivanta, an outsourced game development services company, "Mobile games impose a lot of constraints—for example, limited memory and storage space, limited processing power, limited controls, small display sizes, poor resolution, and so on." Vijay Jain, CEO and CTO of Astute Systems Technology, a developer and publisher of mobile

